

MSE 360: Kinetic Processes in Materials

S2023

Homework 3

Due: January 28, 2023

Instructions: Answer the following questions on a separate piece of paper. Be sure that your name and date are on the first page. Upload your work as a PDF to Moodle for credit. *All work must be done individually.*

1. Answer true or false (and why):

i. For the reaction $A + 2B \rightarrow C$, the rate equation must be: $\frac{dC_A}{dt} = -kC_AC_B^2$.

ii. Decreasing the activation energy of a reaction by half will increase the reaction rate by a factor of 2.

i) F rate eqn. not determined from stoichiometry. Need experiment.

ii) F $k = k_0 \exp(-\Delta G_{act}/RT)$
Rxn rate (dC/dt) is exponentially dependent on ΔG_{act} .

2. Consider the integrated second-order rate law for a reaction which is first order with respect to two distinct reactants (A and B). Prove that the following expressions (Eqns. 3.52 and 3.53 in the textbook) are equivalent:

$$\textcircled{1} C_A = \frac{C_{B0} - \frac{b}{a} C_{A0}}{\frac{C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp[-kt(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0})]} - \frac{b}{a}; \quad \textcircled{2} \frac{C_A}{C_B} = \frac{C_{A0}}{C_{B0}} \exp[kt(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0})]$$

not dependent on C_B

Solve by substituting in Eqn. 1 for C_{B0} to get $\frac{C_A}{C_B}$ (1 substitution)

$$C_B = C_{B0} + \frac{b}{a} (C_A - C_{A0}) \quad \text{Eqn. 3.46}$$

$$C_{B0} = C_B - \frac{b}{a} (C_A - C_{A0})$$

$$\textcircled{1} C_A = \frac{C_{B0} - \frac{b}{a} C_{A0}}{\frac{C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp[-kt(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0})]} - \frac{b}{a}$$

$$C_A = \frac{[C_B - \frac{b}{a} (C_A - C_{A0})] - \frac{b}{a} C_{A0}}{\frac{C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp[-kt(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0})]} - \frac{b}{a}$$

$$C_A = \frac{C_B - \frac{b}{a} C_A + \frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - \frac{b}{a} C_{A0}}{\frac{C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp[-kt(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0})]} - \frac{b}{a}$$

$$C_A \left[\frac{C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp \left(-kt \left(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0} \right) \right) - \frac{b}{a} \right] = C_B - \frac{b}{a} C_A$$

$$\frac{C_A C_{B0}}{C_{A0}} \exp \left[-kt \left(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0} \right) \right] - \cancel{\frac{b}{a} C_A} = C_B - \cancel{\frac{b}{a} C_A}$$

$$\textcircled{2} \quad \boxed{\frac{C_A}{C_B} = \frac{C_{A0}}{C_{B0}} \exp \left[kt \left(\frac{b}{a} C_{A0} - C_{B0} \right) \right]}$$

3. If the rate constant k for a first-order reaction doubles with a change in temperature from $T = 300 \text{ K}$ to $T = 320 \text{ K}$, what is ΔG_{act} ?

Set up ratio of k_1/k_2 & solve for ΔG_{act}

$$k_2 = 2k_1$$

$$\frac{k_1}{k_2} = \frac{K_0 \exp(-\Delta G_{act}/RT_1)}{K_0 \exp(-\Delta G_{act}/RT_2)}$$

$$\frac{k_1}{k_2} = \exp\left[-\frac{\Delta G_{act}}{R}\left(\frac{1}{T_1} - \frac{1}{T_2}\right)\right]$$

$$\Delta G_{act} = -R \ln \frac{k_1}{k_2} \rightarrow k_2 = 2k_1$$
$$\frac{1}{T_1} - \frac{1}{T_2}$$

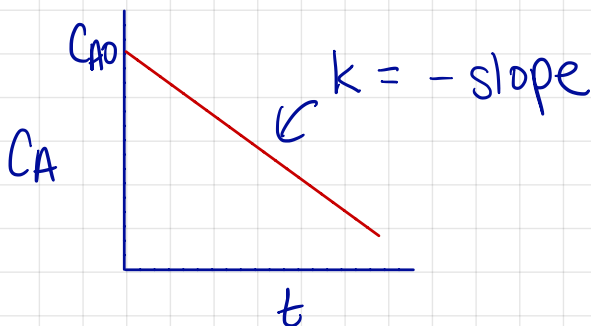
$$= \frac{-8.314 \text{ J/mol}\cdot\text{K} \ln 0.5}{\frac{1}{300\text{K}} - \frac{1}{320\text{K}}}$$

$$\Delta G_{act} = 27.7 \text{ kJ/mol}$$

4. For a 0, 1st, and 2nd-order reaction with respect to the concentration of reactant A, explain how to determine k , the rate constant, from data of the concentration of A vs. time.
Use graphs to support your explanation.

0 order

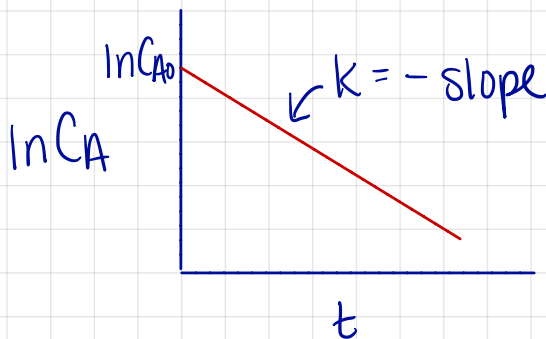
$$C_A = C_{A0} - kt \Rightarrow \text{plot of } C_A \text{ vs. } t \text{ is linear}$$



1st order

$$C_A = C_{A0} \exp(-kt)$$

$$\ln C_A = \ln C_{A0} - kt \Rightarrow \text{plot of } \ln C_A \text{ vs. } t \text{ is linear}$$



2nd - order

$$\frac{1}{C_A} = \frac{1}{C_{A0}} + kt \Rightarrow \text{plot of } \frac{1}{C_A} \text{ vs. } t \text{ is linear}$$

